

JUAN FRANCISCO MARGITIC

✉ juan.margitic@gmail.com | 🏠 www.juanmargitic.com | 🌐 [jmarginic](https://jmarginic.com) | 🌐 [juan-margitic](https://juan-margitic.com)

Relevant Experience

Inter-American Development Bank

Washington, DC

Economist

June 2021 - May 2024

- Led advanced statistical analyses and econometric modeling with R and Python across 10+ countries, informing regional education strategies and yielding flagship publications, and peer-reviewed articles with actionable insights.
- Specialized in advanced causal inference techniques (e.g., A/B testing, Regression Discontinuity design), providing expert technical advice that strengthened project design, implementation, and evaluation, leading to impactful policy solutions.
- Optimized data visualization using Python and R, enhancing advocacy and policy programming used to support effective data-driven decision-making for senior management, government officials, and key stakeholders.
- Led a Randomized Controlled Trial in Recife, Brazil, providing key insights for designing centralized assignment systems.
- Supervised the development of database systems for measuring and monitoring educational indicators at [CIMA - IADB](#).
- Managed and coordinated multidisciplinary teams and budgets, leading data-driven projects across 10+ countries, ensuring timely delivery and enhanced outcomes through effective project management and strategic leadership.
- Coordinated collaborations with international organizations (UNESCO IIEP, World Bank) and senior government officials, providing data-driven insights to optimize educational expenditures and policies in Brazil, Costa Rica, Haiti, and Guyana.

Georgetown University

Washington, DC

Economics Ph.D. Researcher

Aug. 2015 - May 2021

- Conducted causal inference analysis using advanced econometric techniques, generating insights for economic research.
- Executed geospatial analysis with PostGIS and QGIS on over 15 million voters in Georgia and Pennsylvania, recovering the causal impact of distance on turnout and using structural models to optimize polling place allocations.
- Led data mining and processing projects using Python and SQL, including scraping the complete universe of cost estimates for all bills introduced in Congress from 1997 to 2014, ensuring high data quality for advanced econometric modeling.
- Developed a web scraper in Python and R to create a novel dataset of candidate visits and rallies from 2008 to 2016, enabling detailed analysis of electoral dynamics and campaign strategies.
- Disseminated research findings through presentations at seminars, enhancing data literacy among diverse audiences.
- Streamlined workflows for managing and analyzing large datasets in SQL, improving scalability for advanced analytics.

Instructor / Teaching Assistant

Aug. 2016 - May 2020

- Designed and taught graduate and undergraduate courses in data analysis, statistics, and microeconomics to classes of 30 to 150 students, deepening understanding of complex economic systems and applying in-class lessons to real-world scenarios.

Education

Georgetown University

Washington, DC

Ph.D. in Economics,

Aug. 2015 - May 2021

Master of Arts (MA) in Economics

Aug. 2015 - May 2017

Loyola Marymount University

Los Angeles, CA

Bachelor of Science (BSc) in Economics, Minor in Pure Mathematics, Magna Cum Laude

Aug. 2011 - Dec. 2014

Skills

Technical: R, Python, Stata, SQL, GIS (ArcGIS/QGIS), Git, L^AT_EX, Data Visualization (ggplot2, Matplotlib, Tableau)

Languages: English (Fluent), Spanish (Native), Italian and Portuguese (Elementary)

Machine Learning Specialization by Stanford University/**DeepLearning.AI** covering *Advanced Learning Algorithms*, *Unsupervised Learning*, *Recommenders*, *Reinforcement Learning*, and *Supervised Methods: Regression and Classification*.

Selected Publications & Working Papers

“Polling Place Location and the Costs of Voting”, with Gaurav Bagwe and Allison Stashko. (*R&R American Economic Journal: Economic Policy*)

“Food Stamps and America’s Poorest”, with Dean Jolliffe, Martin Ravallion, and Laura Tiehen. (*American Journal of Agricultural Economics* 1–30) - **2024 AAEEA’s Quality of Research Discovery Award**
Featured in: *Vox*, *VoxEU*, *WJS Blog: Real Time Economics*, *Quartz*, *World Economic Forum*

“Lifting the Floor? Economic Development, Social Protection and the Developing World’s Poorest”, with Martin Ravallion. (*Journal of Development Economics* 139 (2019): 97–108)